

NUTS & SEEDS

A 10-Page Sample Guide to Nuts and Edible Seeds

This sample PDF introduces ten items with a short description and one interesting fact for each.

Prepared as a sample educational document

1. Almond

Almonds are edible seeds from the fruit of the almond tree. They are commonly eaten raw, roasted or ground into flour, butter and other foods.

Key fact: The almond that people eat is the seed inside the almond fruit's hard shell.

2. Walnut

Walnuts have a wrinkled, brain-like kernel surrounded by a hard shell. They are eaten whole, chopped into dishes or used in baking.

Key fact: Walnuts are botanically unusual because the part people eat is a seed rather than a true botanical nut.

3. Cashew

Cashews are kidney-shaped seeds attached to the bottom of a cashew apple. They are popular as snacks and are also used in sauces, curries and nut-based products.

Key fact: Raw cashew shells contain irritating compounds, so commercially sold cashews are carefully processed before eating.

4. Pistachio

Pistachios are seeds that develop inside hard shells which often split naturally as they mature. They are eaten as snacks and used in desserts, sauces and savory dishes.

Key fact: The natural splitting of a mature pistachio shell is known as dehiscence.

5. Peanut

Peanuts are legumes rather than true botanical nuts, but they are commonly grouped with nuts in food. The plants produce pods underground, with each pod usually containing one or more seeds.

Key fact: Peanut plants form their pods below the soil surface.

6. Chia Seeds

Chia seeds are tiny seeds that can absorb water and form a gel-like coating. They are commonly added to oatmeal, yogurt, puddings, smoothies and baked foods.

Key fact: Chia seeds can absorb many times their own weight in water.

7. Flaxseeds

Flaxseeds are small brown or golden seeds from the flax plant. They are often ground before eating and can be added to cereals, smoothies and baked foods.

Key fact: Whole flaxseeds are harder to digest than ground flaxseeds, so grinding can improve their availability.

8. Pumpkin Seeds

Pumpkin seeds are edible seeds found inside pumpkins and other squash. They can be eaten roasted, added to salads and soups, or used as a crunchy topping.

Key fact: Pumpkin seeds are sometimes called pepitas, especially when sold without their outer white hull.

9. Sunflower Seeds

Sunflower seeds come from the large flower heads of sunflower plants. They are eaten as snacks and are also pressed to produce sunflower oil.

Key fact: A mature sunflower head can contain hundreds or even thousands of individual seeds.

10. Sesame Seeds

Sesame seeds are tiny seeds used in breads, sauces, spice blends and many Asian, Middle Eastern and African foods. They can be white, golden, brown or black.

Key fact: Sesame is one of the oldest oilseed crops cultivated by humans.